

Chapter 152 - Part 2

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By the time Xu Qingzhu's plane landed, it was already evening.

Evenings in Haizhou City were very cold. The temperature had just dropped, and she felt the chill as soon as she got off the plane.

People were coming and going all around, extremely noisy.

The assistant helped carry her luggage while she walked ahead holding her phone.

Having been on silent for over ten hours on the plane, her phone was flooded with messages as soon as she turned it on. However, they were mostly from Sally and Lin Luoxi chatting in the group, plus some from work staff.

During this time, Liang Shi had only sent three messages.

【Babe, I'm going to film.】

【Be careful on your way.】

【Remember to let me know when you're back.】

There was some time between each message, which was still considerate.

If it had been before, Xu Qingzhu would definitely have been very happy to receive these messages. She might have already had the driver take the car to their production set to see her first. But now she just stared at the screen in deep thought.

In the end, she didn't reply to anything.

She had already had that dream more than once.

After getting drunk, she indeed couldn't remember anything. When she woke up the next day, her mood was still low, and her mind felt like it had been violently torn apart by something.

That day, Xu Qingzhu got up and went for a walk on the foreign streets. Because she was absent-minded, she was nearly hit by a car.

Even though it was only a near miss, her arm was still scraped a little.

It wasn't serious, but for someone with her sensitive skin, it looked quite obvious.

The assistant was terrified at the time, but Xu Qingzhu showed no reaction. She disinfected it, applied medicine, then lay on the bed in her room and slept again.

Once again repeating that dream.

She had always thought sleeping was a happy thing, but now it had become the thing she feared most.

But not sleeping left her with nothing to do.

Besides meeting clients to discuss business, she was just handling company matters online.

Occasionally, she would have hours-long overseas calls with Su Zhe, discussing the company's future development plans.

Minghui and Haiwei—both enterprises had their own merits.

Minghui, as an established jewelry company, had reputation and sentiment. Haiwei, having emerged from thousands of jewelry companies to become an industry benchmark, showed it had followed the trends of the times.

The two companies were no longer in competition now, and Su Zhe had helped Xu Qingzhu a lot in this regard.

Xu Qingzhu could even vaguely sense that Su Zhe was grooming her to be an heir.

Even though they weren't competitors, they were still different companies in the same industry. Yet Su Zhe didn't hide any of Haiwei's internal decisions from her. He even intentionally or unintentionally gave her pointers on how to grow and strengthen a company.

It seemed like he had the intention of merging the two companies.

Su Zhe had even used the example of federation and confederation to explain it to her before.

Xu Qingzhu knew that the younger siblings of the Su family had no intention of entering the company. One just wanted to focus on design, and the other was dead set on medical school. Su Zhe had no attachment to power and status.

Occasionally, he would tell Xu Qingzhu that if it weren't for what happened back then, Haiwei Jewelry wouldn't have gotten this far.

The implication was that if it weren't for trying to bring down Minghui, Su Zhe would definitely have been a carefree rich second generation, just like Su Meiqi now.

Su Zhe even made fun of himself, saying that Su Meiqi being like this now was purely inherited from him.

How come she didn't inherit even a bit of her mother's diligence?

Xu Qingzhu didn't refuse Su Zhe's kindness. Since Haiwei was willing to help Minghui now, she could save some effort. Moreover, in the fiercely competitive business world, having someone willing to lend a hand was absolutely beneficial without any drawbacks.

Furthermore, in Su Zhe's words, without Su Yao, Haiwei wouldn't have become what it was today.

So since Su Yao had a share in Haiwei Jewelry, Xu Qingzhu also had a share.

He didn't treat Xu Qingzhu as an outsider at all.

Even having taken over the affairs of two companies, Xu Qingzhu could still handle them with ease.

It was just that when it came to her own life, she felt rather powerless.

The effects of not sleeping well were far-reaching.

Within two days, she had already lost her temper at the assistant four times, scaring the assistant into being on edge. Even calling her for meals had to be done carefully.

This assistant was also temporarily hired, but she was quite smart with high education and high emotional intelligence. Xu Qingzhu admired her quite a bit.

In two months on the job, she had almost never lost her temper at her.

But now, in just two short days, four times.

The same frequency as her meals.

Not only was the assistant scared, but even Xu Qingzhu herself was scared. She always felt like she had some kind of illness.

She had already scheduled a comprehensive physical examination online.

She had completely forgotten what she talked about with Liang Shi after drinking too much that day, but she could still vaguely guess that Liang Shi knew something about her condition.

And knew quite a bit.

But she didn't even have the desire to ask.

There was always a voice reminding her that even if she asked, she would only get a deceitful answer.

Better not to ask.

Not sleeping well, not eating well—it made her mood extremely terrible.

Nothing could improve it.

Like right now, she simply didn't want to reply to Liang Shi's messages.

She didn't know what was wrong.

After taking the suitcase from the carousel, the assistant followed her out of the station. The driver was already waiting at the exit. As soon as she got in the car, Xu Qingzhu closed her eyes to rest.

But two seconds later, she opened them again.

She couldn't sleep. If she slept, she would have nightmares again.

This had truly become an unsolvable problem.

So, feeling rather bored, Xu Qingzhu opened her phone to go online. After logging into her side account, she found that a blogger she followed had posted on Weibo.

It was a daily post from Liang Shi at the production set.

The boxed lunch from the set and a fresh selfie of her.

The posting date was noon today.

She was quite good at fan service.¹ The photos she posted had no obvious Photoshop traces—it was a fake bare-face look.

Due to the plot requirements, her hair had been straightened, dyed black, and cut a bit shorter.

One could only catch a glimpse from the photos.

The two of them hadn't video called for several days because whenever they did, Xu Qingzhu would want to drink to numb herself.

Liang Shi had noticed this too, so she hadn't initiated any video calls.

It was as if an invisible rope was twisting the two of them, making neither of them feel good.

Xu Qingzhu liked this Weibo post, then tapped to view the full-size image.

1. Fan service / 營業 (yíngyè): In the entertainment industry context, this refers to celebrities actively engaging with fans through social media posts, selfies, and interactions to maintain their public image and fanbase. Literally means "doing business." ↩